

Robotics-for-Cacao Barter

Follow-up action item · TrueSight DAO / Agroverse · 2026-08-06

Context. Three field priorities raised by Gary Teh: harvesting cacao, cutting off witches' broom (*vassoura-de-bruxa*, *Moniliophthora perniciosa*), and cacao roasting flavor-profile control. A new partner — Gianluca, a robotics design expert — was introduced on WhatsApp (reference: Reuters' Frasky precision-ag vineyard robot, youtu.be/hg8qYrjyYCU). This follow-up turns that introduction into a concrete pilot.

1 · The problem on the farm

- **Witches' broom** is the single highest-leverage canopy disease in Bahia cacao: infected brooms must be pruned out **and removed from the plantation** in dry season, or spores reinfect — cutting yields by 30–50% on affected trees.
- **Labor shortage:** pruning and selective pod harvest are manual, seasonal, and hard to staff.
- **Cash constraint:** smallholders have little cash but hold **cacao** — the natural payment asset.

2 · The proposal (barter model)

Offer robotics services to Bahia/Pará farmers **in exchange for cacao as payment**:

Role	Who
Robot design & build	Gianluca (robotics design expert)
Farmer network & deployment	Agroverse — Matheus (Ilhéus warehouse / Black King CNPJ), Oscar's farm (Bahia)
Market for cacao received	TrueSight DAO / Agroverse (US import via TrueTech Inc, live)

Honest MVP scoping. Broom *detection + pruning* (or monitoring + targeted treatment, à la Frasky) is tractable now. *Selective cacao pod harvesting* is harder R&D — set expectations so the pilot stays deliverable.

3 · Pilot plan (1 season, measured)

1. **Scoping call with Gianluca** — define the MVP build, season timing, and cost basis.
2. **Farmer pitch (PT-BR)** — value prop: labor shortage, broom yield loss, **no cash outlay**, paid in cacao at fair market BRL.
3. **2–3 test farms** via Matheus + Oscar's farm (Ilhéus, Bahia).
4. **Barter accounting** — value cacao received at market BRL/USD; record as INVENTORY MOVEMENT + purchase into the Main Ledger (see SUPPLY_CHAIN_AND_FREIGHTING.md).
5. **Measure, then scale** — % broom removed, harvest kg, labor-hours saved. No scaling on unmeasured evidence.

4 · Next steps (owners)

- **Gary + Sophia** — approve outreach copy; introduce Gianluca (WhatsApp).
- **Sophia** — draft scoping-call question list; PT-BR farmer pitch routed via Matheus.
- **Gianluca** — feasibility call; MVP definition.
- **Matheus** — identify 2–3 test farms; coordinate season logistics.

5 · Tie-back to mission

Every broom pruned and every robot-assisted harvest keeps more trees producing and more **Amazon rainforest standing** — the DAO's 10,000-hectare regeneration goal is served by making cacao farming viable without clearing new land.

Filed in `agentic_ai_context/OPEN_FOLLOWUPS.md` (PR #733) · nothing sent to any party yet — awaiting governor approval of outreach copy.